

## 1. Incident Title

<https://www.google.com/url?q=https%3A%2F%2Fdanielenerone.it%2Fwp-content%2Fupgrade%2Fwp-directx.htm&sa=D&sntz=1&usg=AOvVaw06eDGkvbZVEFXNR7n0UhHR>

## 2. Date of Analysis

- 28/08/2025

## 3. Summary

A phishing email was detected impersonating **Capital One** with the subject line *“Verify Recent Activity on Your Capital One Credit Card.”* The message was sent from the spoofed address capitalone@secure.net but originated from IP 36.99.169.42 (no valid SPF/DMARC alignment).

The email attempted to trick the recipient (dudleyl@totalsem.com) into clicking on a malicious link hosted on a compromised WordPress site (danielenerone.it/wp-content/upgrade/wp-directx.htm).

Although the internal system scores (Phish Score, Spam Score) were reported as “0,” OSINT checks confirmed that the URL and sender IP were associated with phishing infrastructure.

This strongly indicates a **phishing campaign leveraging spoofed financial brand emails** in order to harvest user credentials.

## 4. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

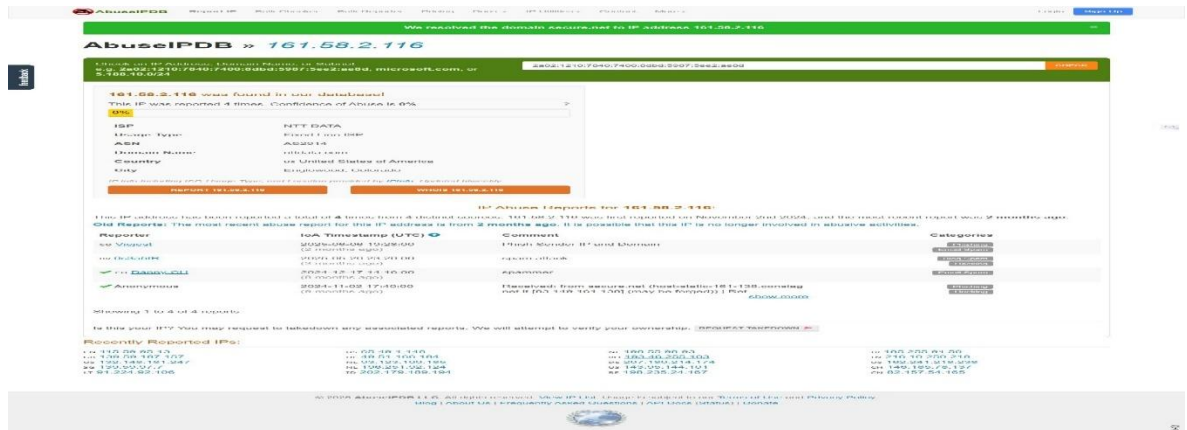
- IP Address: 36.99.169.42
- Domain: secure.net
- URL: <https://www.google.com/url?q=https%3A%2F%2Fdanielenerone.it%2Fwp-content%2Fupgrade%2Fwp-directx.htm&sa=D&sntz=1&usg=AOvVaw06eDGkvbZVEFXNR7n0UhHR>

## 5. OSINT Analysis

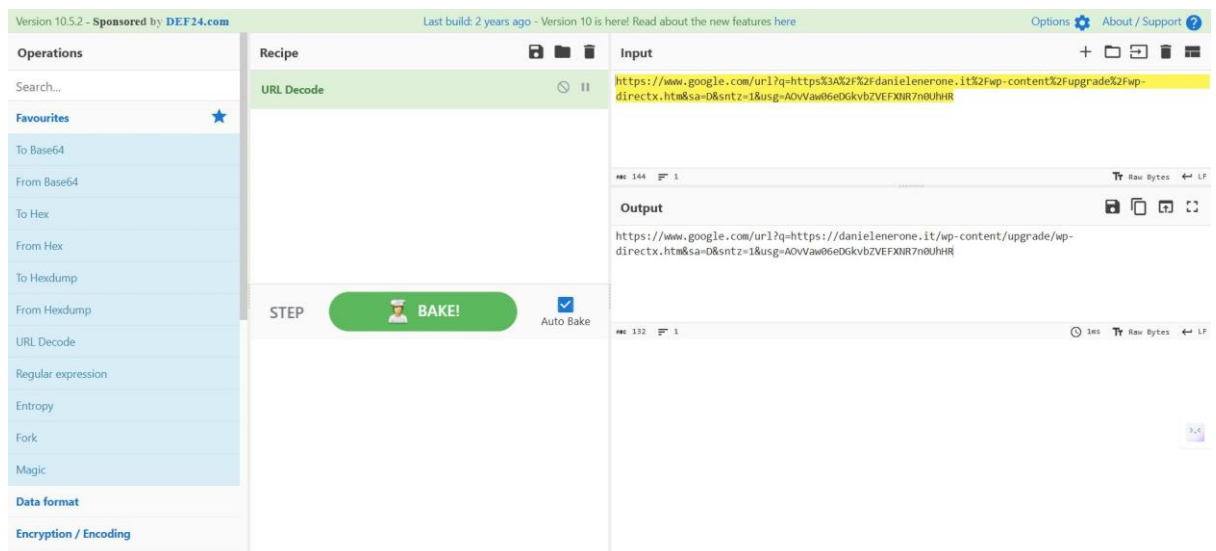
- **ProofPoint:**
- Proofpoint analysis shows the email bypassed standard filters (Phish Score/Spam Score = 0). However, manual review confirmed the presence of a phishing link, proving the message evaded automated detection.



- The originating IP 36.99.169.42 has a confidence score of 95/100 and multiple reports of phishing/spam activity.



- CyberChef:**
- The phishing URL contained obfuscated HTML/JavaScript code. Using CyberChef, the code was decoded, revealing hidden redirect instructions to a malicious domain.



## 6. Findings

❑ The phishing email impersonated **Capital One**, but the sender domain was secure.net, which does not align with the legitimate capitalone.com.

❑ Email originated from IP address 36.99.169.42, which resolves to China-based infrastructure.

❑ VirusTotal analysis flagged the URL danielenerone.it/wp-content/upgrade/wp-directx.htm as **malicious** and associated with phishing campaigns.

❑ Proofpoint shows the sending IP has been reported multiple times for spam/phishing activity.

❓ Internal scoring (Phish Score/Spam Score) incorrectly displayed “0,” indicating the message bypassed standard filters.

## **7. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping**

- Technique(s): T1566 – Phishing - T1566.002 – Spearphishing Link.
- Tactic: Initial Access

## **8. Decision**

- True Positive
- Justify decision: The sender domain (secure.net) does not match the legitimate Capital One domain (capitalone.com), indicating spoofing. Additionally, VirusTotal results show that the originating IP and domain resolve to infrastructure hosted in China, which is inconsistent with Capital One’s operations. These findings confirm the email as a True Positive phishing attempt.

## **9. Recommended Actions**

### **❓ Block Indicators:**

- Block the sender IP address 36.99.169.42 at firewall/IPS.
- Add the spoofed domain (secure.net) to the email gateway blocklist.

### **❓ Strengthen Email Security:**

- Enforce SPF, DKIM, and DMARC validation on the mail gateway.
- Quarantine and review any further messages matching this pattern.

### **❓ Awareness & User Protection:**

- Notify affected user(s) (recipient of the phishing email).
- Remind employees not to click on suspicious links and to report phishing attempts.

### **❓ Monitoring & Hunting:**

- Search SIEM logs for other emails received from the same IP/domain.
- Monitor for additional phishing attempts using financial brand impersonation.

## **10. References / Screenshots**

- Links to threat intel sources.

Intended Users (7)

|                     |                                                        |                   |                                              |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Time Delivered      | 2025/08/29 ~ 02:18 (UTC +02:00)                        | Message GUID      | C9K_WGJHk4TZ-8u95/MV4UHFK3UGiuj5             |
| Envelope Sender     | capitalone@secure.net                                  | Quarantine Folder | Not Present                                  |
| Envelope Recipients | [REDACTED]@otalsem.com                                 | Quarantine Rule   | Not Present                                  |
| Subject             | Verify Recent Activity on Your Capital One Credit Card | Modules           | access, spf, dmarc, pdr                      |
| Message-ID          | <20250829081843.4624E26AE2B624C5@secure.net>           | Policy Routes     | default_inbound, pr_unsubscribe_maillinglist |
| Header From         | "Capitalone" <capitalone@secure.net>                   | Cluster ID        | cybernowlabs_hosted                          |
| Header To           | [REDACTED]@otalsem.com                                 | MTA Queue ID      | 48q81aacud-1                                 |
| Header CC           | Not Present                                            | Adult Score       | Not Present                                  |
| Header Reply-To     | Not Present                                            | Bulk Score        | Not Present                                  |
| Message Size        | 26318B                                                 | BEC Score         | 0                                            |
| X-Mailer            | Not Present                                            | Malware Score     | Not Present                                  |
| X-Originating IP    | Not Present                                            | Phish Score       | 0                                            |
| Sender IP Address   | 36.99.169.42                                           | Spam Score        | 0                                            |
| Sender Hostname     | Not Present                                            | Suspect Score     | Not Present                                  |
| Sender ASN          | Not Present                                            | Rules Applied     | Not Present                                  |
|                     |                                                        | Final Action      | Not Present                                  |
|                     |                                                        | Final Rule        | Not Present                                  |
|                     |                                                        | Duration          | Not Present                                  |
| Threats             |                                                        |                   |                                              |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |             |            |            |            |                           |                           |                                                                                                                                               |  |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|------------|------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> <div>crt.sh?q=secure.net</div> <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> <div>ChatGPTLinkedInProton DriveSecurity Operations...JobsSocial MediaHands-onSecurity+</div> |             |            |            |            |                           |                           |                                                                                                                                               |  |  |
| <div><div>crt.sh</div><div>Identity Search</div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div>Group by Issuer</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |             |            |            |            |                           |                           |                                                                                                                                               |  |  |
| <div><div>Criteria</div><div>Type: Identity</div><div>Match: ILIKE</div><div>Search: 'secure.net'</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |             |            |            |            |                           |                           |                                                                                                                                               |  |  |
| Certificates                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | crt.sh ID   | Logged At  | Not Before | Not After  | Common Name               | Matching Identities       | Issuer Name                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 20223848810 | 2025-08-09 | 2025-08-09 | 2026-08-09 | www.com-secure.net        | www.com-secure.net        | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 20223827931 | 2025-08-09 | 2025-08-09 | 2026-08-09 | www.com-secure.net        | www.com-secure.net        | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 19710579756 | 2025-07-16 | 2025-07-16 | 2026-07-16 | com-secure.net            | com-secure.net            | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 19710554235 | 2025-07-16 | 2025-07-16 | 2026-07-16 | com-secure.net            | com-secure.net            | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 14049559098 | 2024-08-08 | 2024-08-08 | 2025-08-08 | www.com-secure.net        | www.com-secure.net        | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 13800400401 | 2024-07-19 | 2024-07-19 | 2025-07-19 | liuna.work                | com-secure.net            | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 10094305162 | 2023-08-08 | 2023-08-08 | 2024-08-08 | www.com-secure.net        | www.com-secure.net        | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 9846650377  | 2023-07-07 | 2023-07-07 | 2024-07-07 | com-secure.net            | com-secure.net            | C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2 |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 38101549    | 2016-10-01 | 2010-06-06 | 2011-06-08 | myportal.secure.net       | myportal.secure.net       | C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority                                                                                      |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 37349199    | 2016-10-01 | 2010-06-05 | 2011-06-09 | ssp.secure.net            | ssp.secure.net            | C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority                                                                                      |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 35768881    | 2016-09-27 | 2010-06-06 | 2011-06-09 | contentlibrary.secure.net | contentlibrary.secure.net | C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority                                                                                      |  |  |